Table 11-9. *Some HTML inline elements*

`<span>`	Generic inline container for grouping/styling
`<a>`	Anchor: defines hyperlinks
`<img>`	Embed an image
`<input>`, `<label>`	Inputs and associated labels inside `<form>`
`<button>`	Creates a clickable button

I could go on… for chapters and chapters, but that is not the point of this book. If you've found your appetite whetted for front-end development, then you could do a lot worse than starting with the Mozilla Developer Network's introductory tutorials on the subject, found at https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn_web_development/Getting_started

The Document Object Model

This section so far constitutes the bare minimum of HTML knowledge you'll need for the remaining PHP-focused material, but there's one concept we should look at because it transfers over to PHP, and that's the *Document Object Model* (aka DOM). The DOM is an in-memory data structure used by the browser to represent the HTML document and to connect pages to their scripts. JavaScript can make changes to the DOM, which are then reflected by updates to the rendered page. In addition to the structure of the page, the browser DOM also exposes a number of APIs for interacting with the document, elements of the document, events, and even the browser itself (with certain secure limits).

At the risk of being accused of putting the cart before the horse, I'm going to first show how to manipulate existing HTML (and XML) in PHP (e.g., your code is consuming markup from an external API or website). Then with these lessons firmly secure in your mind, we can dive into techniques for generating your own markup from scratch, safe in the knowledge that you'll have a very clear idea of what well-formed markup should look like. DOM manipulation is also a very common requirement when writing client-side JavaScript, and most PHP developers (including me) will usually have to get their hands dirty with front-end code at some point. The concepts presented here transfer quite readily to code written for execution in a web browser context, I promise!